



The Morning Brief

MAY 5, 2026

Convoy Meets Counter

*Iran retaliates with UAE missile barrage as Project Freedom moves two vessels through Hormuz;
Palantir beats but trades flat after-hours; AMD reports tonight.*

S&P 500 (MON CLOSE)	DOW (MON CLOSE)	BRENT (INTRADAY MON)	BITCOIN (LIVE)	FEAR & GREED
7,201 · ↓0.41%	48,942 · ↓1.13%	~\$114 · 4-yr high	\$81,135 · ↑Reclaimed \$80K	40 · Fear

SECTION 01

Markets

CONVOY DAY ONE RESETS THE TAPE — CYCLICALS LEAD THE DECLINE AS BRENT TOUCHES A FOUR-YEAR HIGH

The S&P 500 closed Monday at 7,200.75, down 0.41%, ending a five-session streak of fresh closing highs as the Iranian missile barrage on the UAE and Brent's push above \$114 (a four-year high per Trading Economics and CNBC reporting) reversed the Friday rotation framework. The Dow shouldered the brunt at -1.13% (-557 points to 48,941.90 per TheStreet and CNBC compilations) as industrials and discretionary cyclicals absorbed the demand-shock implications, while the Nasdaq held relatively firm at -0.19% (25,067.80) on continued AI-edge bid. WTI settled near \$102 and Brent near \$110 after intraday spikes per Trading Economics coverage. Carson's \$645.80 SPY support remains active and well below current levels — the active retracement window now sits roughly 10.5% below Monday's SPY close.

PALANTIR BEATS AND RAISES — FLAT AFTER-HOURS REACTION REFRAMES THE AI-MULTIPLE QUESTION

Palantir reported Monday after the close with adjusted EPS of \$0.33 versus \$0.28 consensus on revenue of \$1.63B (+84.7% YoY) per CNBC and Motley Fool coverage, materially exceeding the \$1.54B Street forecast and accelerating from prior quarters. Management guided Q2 revenue to \$1.8B versus \$1.68B LSEG consensus and raised the 2026 outlook to \$7.65-\$7.66B versus \$7.27B prior consensus, citing eleven consecutive quarters of accelerating revenue growth and 1,007 commercial customers (+31% YoY) per the company release. PLTR traded roughly flat in extended trade despite the print — a muted reaction analysts attributed to the company's elevated valuation per Motley Fool coverage, suggesting the multiple bar requires more than a beat-and-

raise sequence to extend. The read-through to IOWN's AI-edge growth complex (CRDO, MRVL, NXPI, KEYS, LRCX) is mixed: commercial AI demand is accelerating, but multiple compression risk is reasserting itself even on strong fundamentals.

AMD TONIGHT BECOMES THE CLEANER READ — DATA CENTER ABOVE \$5.6B IS THE BULL CASE

AMD reports today after the close with consensus EPS of \$1.27-\$1.29 on \$9.84B revenue (+32-33% YoY) per TradingKey and Bitget compilations, against management's prior \$9.8B Q1 guide. Zacks consensus for the Data Center segment sits at \$5.56B (+51.5% YoY) per the heygotrade and TradingKey previews. The principal narrative levers are MI350 ramp commentary, MI450 second-half timing, the

Meta multi-gigawatt cluster build, and Q2 guidance — the bull case requires Data Center above \$5.6B paired with a Q2 raise. Gross margin guidance of approximately 55% non-GAAP versus 57% in Q4 2025 is the principal structural concern; a print below 54% would signal product-mix pressure from the MI350 ramp. AMD trades into the print after April's 74% advance per Motley Fool coverage. The IOWN growth sleeve carries direct exposure through AMD with broader read-across to NVDA mid-month.

ISM SERVICES AND JOLTS PRINT TODAY — THE FIRST APRIL READ ON SERVICES DEMAND LANDS AT 10:00 AM ET

The ISM Services PMI for April releases at 10:00 AM ET, the first read on the services sector following last week's ISM Manufacturing 52.7 print per ISM coverage. March printed 54.0%, the 21st consecutive month of expansion territory but down 2.1 points from February's 56.1% per ISM and PRNewswire compilations. JOLTS for March prints alongside, with the March US trade balance on the calendar this

week per BEA scheduling. The macro signal sits between two crosscurrents: services-sector resilience would reinforce the soft-landing framing the Fed's 8–4 hawkish dissent FOMC is leaning into, while a downside surprise would amplify the demand-shock concerns the oil spike has reintroduced. The IOWN dividend sleeve's rate-sensitive defensives (ATO, BKH, NEE, DGX) and consumer staples (CL, CHD) carry the principal forward sensitivity to the services prints.

S&P 500 (MON)	7,200.75 · ↓0.41% · Streak ends
DOW / NASDAQ (MON)	48,942 ↓1.13% · 25,068 ↓0.19%
BRENT / WTI (INTRADAY)	~\$114 · ~\$102 · 4-yr Brent high
PLTR (AFTER-HRS)	Flat · Beat-and-raise muted
CARSON'S ACTIVE LEVEL	SPY \$645.80 support · ~10.5% below Mon close
TODAY'S CATALYSTS	ISM Services · JOLTS · AMD AMC · FTNT/COIN/ HOOD week

When the convoy meets the counter, refining margins extend and the AI-multiple bar resets — the question for the IOWN committee is whether AMD's data-center print can re-anchor the AI-edge thesis as the demand-shock framework reasserts. Research Reveals Opportunities.

Geopolitics

IRAN'S FIRST UAE STRIKE SINCE THE APRIL 8 CEASEFIRE — 12 BALLISTIC MISSILES, 3 CRUISE MISSILES, 4 DRONES INTERCEPTED

The United Arab Emirates Defense Ministry reported Monday that its air defenses intercepted 12 ballistic missiles, three cruise missiles, and four drones launched by Iran — the first attack on the UAE since the April 8 US-Iran ceasefire per CNBC, Al Jazeera, NPR, and Gulf News coverage. Three Indian citizens sustained moderate injuries and a drone sparked a fire at the Fujairah Petroleum Industries Zone per Al Jazeera reporting. The strikes coincided with the launch of Project Freedom in the Strait of Hormuz, with Iran's IRGC stating publicly that any US intervention in the strait would be viewed as a violation of the April 8 ceasefire per Al Jazeera. Trump told Fox News that Iran would be “blown off the face of the earth” if it targeted US ships, while notably avoiding language declaring the ceasefire formally violated per CNBC and Al Jazeera coverage. The IOWN integrated-energy sleeve (CVX, VLO, OKE, CTRA, CNX) and defense exposure (LMT, GD) carry the principal forward sensitivity to a duration-extending standoff, with refining margins materially elevated as Brent touched a four-year high.

PROJECT FREEDOM DAY ONE — TWO VESSELS TRANSIT HORMUZ VERSUS PRE-WAR FLOW OF 120 PER DAY

CENTCOM's Admiral Brad Cooper confirmed Monday that two US-flagged merchant vessels transited the Strait of Hormuz under naval escort in the first hours of Project Freedom per CNN and Foreign Policy coverage, with US Navy destroyers shooting down Iranian cruise missiles targeting them and US helicopters sinking six small Iranian boats attempting to attack commercial shipping per CNBC and NPR reporting. Iran's Fars news agency claimed two missiles struck a US frigate near the Gulf of Oman port of Jask — a claim the US military denied per CNBC and Al Jazeera. Retired US Army Lieutenant General Karen Gibson called Day One a “tactical success” per CNN, while observing that the throughput must be measured against the pre-war flow of approximately 120 vessels per day per Breaking Defense and CNN coverage. The implication for the integrated-energy thesis: physical supply normalization remains a multi-week project at best, the refining-margin window remains intact, and the duration-extending standoff continues to support the IOWN energy sleeve's structural exposure.

THE CEASEFIRE FRAMING HOLDS IN WORD BUT NOT IN DEED — TRUMP'S CALCULATED AMBIGUITY PRESERVES OPTIONALITY

Trump declined to declare the April 8 ceasefire violated despite the UAE missile barrage and the live-fire exchange in Hormuz, per CNBC, Al Jazeera, and Haaretz coverage. The

administration's posture preserves the kinetic-action threshold below the formal war-powers framework while continuing convoy operations and counter-strikes in the strait. Iran's Foreign Ministry framed Project Freedom itself as a violation of the ceasefire per Al Jazeera. The diplomatic posture is now bifurcated in a structurally durable way: live-fire exchanges and convoy escorts proceed while political resolution remains elusive, with the 14-point Iranian peace plan rejected on Sunday and no follow-up framework announced. The IOWN portfolio's asymmetric exposure runs through the integrated-energy sleeve on the supply side and the digital-asset complex on the macro-hedging side — Bitcoin reclaimed \$80K Monday and trades at \$81,135 live per Yahoo Finance and Fortune coverage, the first close above \$80K since January 31.

UAE MISSILE STRIKE	12 ballistic + 3 cruise + 4 drones · All intercepted (UAE MoD)
PROJECT FREEDOM DAY 1	2 US-flagged vessels transited · vs ~120/day pre-war (CENTCOM)
US COUNTER-ACTION	6 Iranian small boats sunk · Cruise missiles intercepted (CENTCOM)
BRENT (INTRADAY MON)	~\$114 · 4-yr high · Settled ~\$110
TRUMP POSTURE	“Blown off the face of the earth” · No formal ceasefire violation declared
BITCOIN (LIVE)	\$81,135 · First \$80K reclaim since Jan 31

On Our Radar

1. AMD reports tonight after the close — Data Center above \$5.6B is the bull-case threshold; gross-margin discipline is the structural concern. Consensus per TradingKey and Bitget compilations sits at \$1.27–\$1.29 EPS on \$9.84B revenue (+32–33% YoY), with Zacks Data Center consensus at \$5.56B (+51.5% YoY) per heygotrade preview coverage. The MI350 ramp commentary, MI450 second-half timing, and Meta multi-gigawatt cluster build are the principal narrative levers. Gross margin guidance of approximately 55% non-GAAP versus 57% in Q4 2025 frames the structural concern; a print below 54% would signal product-mix pressure. AMD trades into the print after April's 74% advance per Motley Fool coverage. The IOWN growth sleeve's direct exposure runs through AMD with mid-month NVDA the broader read-across. The Palantir flat-after-hours response despite a beat-and-raise sequence is the cautionary read on multiple discipline. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

2. Bitcoin reclaims \$80K for the first time since January 31 — the digital-asset complex breaks out of its \$75K–\$80K range as the demand-shock framework reasserts. BTC trades at \$81,135 live per Yahoo Finance and Fortune coverage, up over 17% on the trailing month per Yahoo Finance compilations, with Ethereum trading near \$2,381 (+13% on the month). The April ETF flow data confirmed the strongest spot-Bitcoin ETF month of 2026 per CryptoTimes coverage. The macro framing is consistent: when geopolitical tail-risk reasserts and refining-margin spillovers dominate the equity tape, the IOWN digital-asset sleeve (IBIT, ETHA) carries the macro-hedge function. The physical-AI-infrastructure linkage through HUT and MARA — whose River Bend Data Center \$3.25B financing closed last week per Finnhub — remains the IOWN-aligned framing. *The physical world matters.*

3. ISM Services for April prints today at 10:00 AM ET — the first April read on services demand sits between the soft-landing framing and the demand-shock concern. March printed 54.0%, the 21st consecutive month of expansion territory but down 2.1 points from February's 56.1% per ISM and PRNewswire coverage. JOLT'S for March prints alongside, with the March US trade balance on the calendar this week per BEA scheduling. The macro signal sits between the FOMC's 8–4 hawkish dissent posture (which leaned into services-sector resilience) and the Brent \$114 demand-shock concern that has reintroduced itself. A downside surprise on services would amplify the cyclical-sector pressure visible in Monday's –1.13% Dow print; an upside print would reinforce the rate-path stickiness that has anchored the long end (TLT effectively flat per the data drop). *Avoid Erosion.*

4. The IOWN earnings calendar runs deep this week — ABT, ADI, ATO, FAST, FTNT, COIN, HOOD, MRVL, NXPI, OKE, SYF, TSM, TOL, VST in focus. The dividend-sleeve calendar features ABT, ADI, ATO, FAST, ORI, PCAR, STLD, and TEL across the coming sessions per company calendars. The growth-sleeve calendar features AMD tonight, with COIN, FTNT, HOOD, MRVL, NXPI, OKE, SYF, TSM, TOL, and VST distributed through the week. ADI's analog-cycle commentary is the principal cyclical signal — the read-across to NXPI's prior 24% Industrial & IoT growth frames the auto/industrial demand question. STLD on the steel-pricing pass-through and PCAR on Class 8 truck backlog round out the industrial dispersion read. The IOWN growth sleeve's AI-edge concentration carries the multiple-discipline risk as the Palantir muted reaction reframes the bar. *Think Like an Owner.*

5. CTRA exit from the S&P 500 is two sessions away — the Devon merger close coincides with the Thursday May 7 index rebalance. S&P Dow Jones Indices announced Veeva Systems will replace Coterra Energy in the S&P 500 effective prior to Thursday's open per Stocktitan and Benzinga reporting, with the all-stock \$58B Devon–Coterra combination targeted to close on or around May 7 per Devon's investor materials. CTRA shareholders receive 0.70 Devon shares per CTRA share at the close, materially reshaping the IOWN energy sub-sleeve's composition. The pro forma Permian operator targets pro forma production above 1.6M boe/d with \$1.0B annual pre-tax synergies per the merger announcement. Passive S&P tracker rebalancing flows tend to dominate the operative window into the May 6 close. The Hormuz supply-premium backdrop reinforces the Delaware Basin consolidation read-through. *The physical world matters.*

6. The Warsh confirmation full-Senate vote is expected the week of May 11 — Powell's term as chair expires May 15. The Senate Banking Committee's 13–11 strict party-line approval per CNBC, Bloomberg, and Yahoo coverage tees up Warsh for the simple-majority full Senate vote; with Republicans holding 53 seats and Senator Fetterman indicating bipartisan support per Semafor, the path to confirmation is intact. The 8–4 FOMC dissent at last week's meeting was the largest at a single meeting since 1992 per CNBC reporting, suggesting institutional resistance to a Warsh-led pivot remains material. The Brent \$114 demand-shock backdrop complicates the framing transition: a chair signaling a more accommodative posture into a fresh oil-supply premium would face the credibility test the four hawks have already pre-positioned against. The IOWN dividend sleeve's rate-sensitive defensives (ATO, BKH, NEE, DGX) carry the principal forward sensitivity. **Simplicity Over Complexity.**

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